economic reforms at home stalled due to domestic opposition, so largely did the diplomatic opening to America.

The year 1982 also produced new thinking in Beijing and Moscow. China's relations with the US had become difficult over American support to Taiwan. Washington had also slowed the transfer of advanced technologies. It was a good time for a measure of reconciliation with the Soviets: an opening to Moscow would increase Beijing's bargaining room with Washington. Beijing also wanted to reduce the tensions around its borders so that it could focus more on economic reforms at home. For its part, Moscow, confronted by a gung-ho America under Reagan, a China that was in partnership with the US and making strides economically after its 1979 reforms, and a military stalemate in Afghanistan, saw the chance to drive a wedge between China and the US. In addition, Moscow, like Beijing, wanted to focus more on economic development, and easing tensions along the Sino-Soviet border would allow it to concentrate on matters at home.

Over four years, China and the Soviets held nine rounds of talks. Between 1981 and 1986, their bilateral trade grew ten times.[29] In 1985, with the coming to power of Mikhail Gorbachev, the pace of reconciliation increased. Moscow reduced its troops along the boundaries with China and finally accepted that border negotiations were necessary. The two sides moved to normalize diplomatic relations and to stop their ideological name-calling. The Soviets renounced the Brezhnev Doctrine (which justified Soviet intervention in communist countries). In 1986–87, Gorbachev announced that Soviet troops would withdraw from Afghanistan, and by 1989 the last units had pulled out. With this, and the collapse of communism in Eastern Europe, the Cold War ended.

India and China started out the last decade of the Cold War on opposite sides of global politics. Both used the partnerships with powerful protectors to advantage. They would remain geopolitical rivals until the end of the Cold War in 1989, but by 1982 they sensed that the costs of doing so were rising. Before the Soviets and the US wound down the Cold War, India and China had already begun a détente process of their own. As we saw in the